

Development Journey

Our project began with a clear decision to focus on merchants rather than collaborators. As a team, we believed that the long-term future of Snoonu depends on empowering merchants across different verticals such as food, grocery, and services. Instead of treating merchants as simple supply partners, we wanted to explore how Snoonu could become a true growth partner for them. This strategic direction shaped all further decisions in our project.

In the empathy stage, we focused on understanding merchants' real challenges and daily workflows. We spoke with multiple internal stakeholders, including members of the Business Intelligence team and Snoonu's CFO, to understand how the current merchant ecosystem operates. We also reached out directly to several merchants using the platform to hear their concerns first-hand. Through these conversations, we learned that although a merchant portal already exists, it only provides basic statistics such as sales and revenue. More importantly, merchants often do not act on this data because it lacks clarity, context, and guidance. They repeatedly expressed the need for simple, practical insights and tools that could help them make fast decisions without technical complexity.

Based on these findings, we moved into the problem definition stage. We realized that the core issue was not a lack of data, but a lack of actionable direction. Merchants were overwhelmed by numbers, unsure how to improve performance, hesitant to run marketing campaigns, and unable to identify which actions would actually increase revenue or service quality. This resulted in weak adoption of growth features, missed revenue opportunities, and slow business improvement. We formally defined the problem as the absence of a system that translates raw platform data into clear, prioritized, and easy-to-execute business actions for merchants.

During the ideation stage, we explored multiple solution directions. We brainstormed how data, AI, marketing tools, performance feedback, and incentives could be combined into one unified experience. This led to the concept of a Merchant Intelligence Platform integrated directly into Snoonu's existing

merchant portal. The idea was to centralize insights, recommendations, marketing execution, performance feedback, and competitive ranking into a single system that merchants could use daily without training or technical knowledge.

Next, we translated this concept into a prototype. We designed a system with multiple functional areas including an AI-driven action dashboard, a feedback and performance analysis section, a smart marketing campaign builder, a tier-based ranking and rewards system, celebrity collaboration options for high-tier merchants, and a market pulse view that shows local demand trends. The prototype visually demonstrated how merchants would navigate the platform, receive recommendations, track progress, and compete for higher tiers.

To validate our approach, we tested the concept through internal reviews and discussions with merchants. We walked through the platform flow, evaluated whether recommendations were understandable, and assessed whether merchants could realistically apply the suggested actions in daily operations. Feedback confirmed that merchants valued simplicity, automation, and competitive motivation. This helped refine the design to reduce complexity and emphasize short action lists, score progression, and one-click campaign execution.

Finally, we planned the implementation approach. The platform would be integrated directly into Snoonu's existing backend and merchant portal, starting with a limited pilot group of food merchants. After validating performance and usability, it would be gradually rolled out to other merchants and verticals. Internally, the system would reduce the workload on merchant success and support teams by automating performance monitoring and early problem detection. Over time, it would evolve with deeper AI integration, predictive demand modeling, advanced ranking systems, and merchant competitions, creating a scalable foundation for long-term ecosystem growth.

Through this structured process, our team moved from understanding real merchant pain points to delivering a practical, data-driven growth system designed to benefit merchants and strengthen Snoonu's platform at scale.